



Copper-sheathed handle

◀ CONGOLESE AXE

Date 19th century

Origin Congo Basin

Weight 1.35kg (3lb)

Length 42.8cm (17in)

This ornate ceremonial axe is of a type carried by chiefs of the Songye people, from the southeast Congo Basin. The hardwood haft is entirely sheathed in copper, a metal common in the region.



Decorative inlay



Covering made of hide

▲ WEST AFRICAN FIGHTING PICK

Date 19th century

Origin Ghana

Weight 650g (23oz)

Length 51cm (20in)

The barbed head of this unusual fighting pick would have certainly caused a serious wound, but made the weapon potentially difficult to recover.



▲ MAORI CEREMONIAL TOKI

Date 19th century

Origin New Zealand

Maori warriors used the *tiki*, an adze-like weapon with a transverse blade, as well as clubs and *taiahas* (club-spears). This *poutangata* (ceremonial) version has a blade of carved *pounamu* (jade), a symbol of chieftainship.



Openwork iron blade



Cylindrical hardwood shaft

Red bead

◀ MELANESIAN CLUB

Date 19th century

Origin Vanuatu

Weight 600g (21¼oz)

Length 82cm (32in)

This lightweight, ceremonial wooden club has a stylized human face carved on each side of the head. This kind of decoration is frequently found across Oceania.



Human figure carving

◀ TONGAN CLUB

Date 19th century

Origin Tonga

Weight 1.3kg (3lb)

Length 82cm (32in)

This heavy, two-handed war club is carved along its length with geometric patterns, human figures, animals, and fish. The diamond-shaped head would have inflicted a crushing blow to the skull.



▲ POLYNESIAN "CUTLASS"

Date 19th century

Origin Polynesia

Weight 1.5kg (3¼lb)

Length 77.5cm (30½in)

Based on the *ayudha katti* of South India, this cleaver-like club's triangular panels of geometric motifs are reminiscent of patterns found in ceremonial weavings.